

Cagrilintide

Cagrilintide (CAG) — Long-Acting Amylin Analogue

WEIGHT LOSS

AMYLIN

APPETITE

GLP-1 SYNERGY

PHASE 3

WHAT IS IT?

Cagrilintide is a long-acting synthetic analogue of amylin — a pancreatic hormone co-secreted with insulin that signals satiety and slows gastric emptying. Developed by Novo Nordisk, it has a ~7-day half-life (once-weekly dosing) and is being studied in Phase 3 trials as CagriSema (cagrilintide 2.4 mg + semaglutide 2.4 mg). REDEFINE 1 trial data showed ~25% body weight reduction — potentially surpassing every approved weight loss drug on the market. Acts via a completely different receptor than GLP-1 agonists.

DOSING AT A GLANCE

Starting dose	Target dose	Frequency	Ramp-up
0.16 mg/wk	2.4 mg/wk	Once weekly	16-week titration

KEY BENEFITS

- ~25% body weight reduction in REDEFINE 1 trial (CagriSema combination at 68 weeks)
- Amylin receptor activation — entirely different pathway from GLP-1 agonists
- Powerful satiety signaling — reduces meal size and caloric intake
- Slows gastric emptying independently of GLP-1 mechanism
- Synergistic with semaglutide/tirzepatide — additive weight loss when combined
- Reduces postprandial glucose excursions
- Improves metabolic markers: lipids, blood pressure, HbA1c
- Once-weekly injection — excellent compliance profile
- May offer superior weight loss vs. GLP-1 monotherapy alone

HOW IT WORKS

Cagrilintide is an amylin analogue — it binds amylin receptors (which are calcitonin receptor/RAMP complexes) in the area postrema and NTS (nucleus tractus solitarius) in the brainstem, as well as in the hypothalamus. This produces satiety signals independent of GLP-1R activation. The combination with semaglutide provides dual central + peripheral satiety and gastric slowing — explaining the additive weight loss seen in CagriSema trials that exceeds either drug alone.

PROTOCOLS

- **CagriSema titration:** 0.16 mg x4 wks → 0.35 mg x4 → 0.7 mg x4 → 1.4 mg x4 → 2.4 mg.
- **Monotherapy:** Same titration schedule — studied as standalone in Phase 2.
- **Combination:** Pair with semaglutide 2.4 mg/week for maximum fat loss (CagriSema protocol).
- **Protein/exercise:** 1g/lb protein + resistance training mandatory to preserve lean mass.
- **Compounded:** Available from select compounding pharmacies — verify HPLC purity.

SIDE EFFECTS

- Nausea (common, GI class effect — diminishes with titration)
- Injection site reactions (mild erythema, nodules at injection site more common than with GLP-1 alone)
- Constipation, diarrhea
- Hypoglycemia (in combination with insulin or sulfonylureas)
- Muscle mass loss during rapid weight loss phase (mitigate with training + protein)
- Fatigue during initial titration (common)

STORAGE

Refrigerate 2–8°C. Do not freeze. After first use: refrigerate, use within 28 days.

■ **Not yet FDA approved as of 2025 — NDA submission expected 2025–2026. Injection site nodules are more common than with semaglutide alone — rotate sites consistently.**

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